

Frosty Banana Co.

30 cents in. \$3 out. The simplest high-margin treat there is.

What It Is

Frosty Banana Co. sells frozen chocolate-dipped bananas rolled in colorful toppings — sprinkles, crushed nuts, candy, drizzle — for around \$3 each. They cost roughly 30-40 cents to make, look satisfying and fun, and people film them constantly, so the product markets itself. Run it from a stall, cart, kiosk, or stand at markets, beaches, fairs, and busy foot-traffic spots.

How It Makes Money

You sell frozen banana treats at \$3-\$5 each with an 85%+ ingredient margin. Customers are families, kids, beachgoers, festival crowds, and the impulse-snack and social-media audience. Volume is the game — a few hundred a day from one simple product. Add-on toppings, dipped strawberries, and combo deals raise the ticket. The colorful, photogenic look earns free social reach.

Startup Costs

- Chest freezer(s): \$200-\$800 (used market)
- Chocolate melter/warmer: \$60-\$200
- Dipping/prep tools, sticks, trays: \$80-\$250
- Stall, cart, or kiosk + signage: \$500-\$3,000
- Ingredient starting stock (bananas, chocolate, toppings, sticks): \$150-\$400
- Permits, food handler card, commissary: \$200-\$1,000
- Branding, menu board, packaging: \$150-\$400
- **Realistic start: \$1,200-\$5,000**

Sourcing: Buy equipment and supplies from Alibaba — search "chocolate melting tempering machine," "commercial chest freezer," and "ice cream stick wooden bulk." Source bananas, chocolate, and toppings from a local wholesale/restaurant supplier for freshness and cost.

The Numbers

- Cost per banana (banana, chocolate, toppings, stick): ~\$0.35-\$0.55
- Sell price: \$3-\$5
- Profit per banana: ~\$2.50-\$4.50
- Modest day: 100 sold → ~\$300 profit
- Strong day (beach/festival): 250-400 sold → ~\$750-\$1,400 profit
- Monthly at steady market days: \$6,000-\$14,000+ gross profit

How To Start

1. Perfect the dip-and-freeze process so the chocolate sets fast and toppings stick cleanly.
2. Buy a chest freezer and chocolate melter; build a fast assembly line (pre-dip, freeze, top to order).

3. Sort permits, food handler card, and commissary if your city requires it.
4. Build a bright, colorful stall with a clear menu and good lighting.
5. Launch at a high-traffic spot — beach, park, night market, or festival.
6. Film the dipping and topping process daily for Reels/TikTok and tag the location.
7. Add dipped strawberries, combos, and a second market day as demand proves out.

Where To Get Customers

- TikTok and Instagram Reels — the dip-and-topping ASMR is built to go viral
- Beaches, parks, night markets, fairs, and festivals with heavy foot traffic
- Local "things to do / foodie" pages and influencers
- Google Maps / Yelp once you hold a fixed spot
- Catering for birthday parties, school events, and corporate gatherings

Pro Tips

- Pre-dip and freeze in batches, then add toppings to order — that's how you serve a festival rush without a line.
- Use the most colorful toppings even if costlier; visual appeal is what triggers the films and the impulse buys.
- Offer a "rainbow" or build-your-own option as your hero SKU; choice raises both engagement and ticket size.